

Shadow Board

Strategy Brief

Generated: March 19, 2026

Strategic Question:

Should Spotify acquire a podcast analytics company?

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The debate on whether Spotify should acquire a podcast analytics company has culminated in a conditional recommendation due to substantial market potential contrasted with significant financial risks. While the prospect of enhancing creator support and maintaining competitiveness is appealing, concerns over financial feasibility and legal ramifications warrant a cautious approach.

BOARD VOTE

- CFO: NO-GO
- CMO: CONDITIONAL
- Legal Counsel: CONDITIONAL
- Devil's Advocate: NO-GO
- Overall: 0 for GO, 3 for NO-GO, 2 for CONDITIONAL

CONSENSUS POINTS

- The podcast market is projected to grow significantly, with revenues reaching over \$3.9 billion by 2025.
- There is an increasing need for sophisticated analytics among podcast creators for better audience engagement.
- Spotify faces intense competition from other platforms investing heavily in analytics.

KEY DISAGREEMENTS

- CFO and Devil's Advocate believe prior financial losses necessitate cautious investment, highlighting market saturation and operational inefficiencies.
- CMO and Legal Counsel recognize market potential but emphasize the importance of a balanced approach that accounts for integration strategies and legal compliance.

RISK MATRIX

Risk	Severity	Probability	Flagged By
Financial viability of acquisitions	HIGH	MEDIUM	CFO
Market saturation leading to decreased revenue	HIGH	HIGH	Devil's Advocate
Legal exposure from content management compliance	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Legal Counsel

OPTIONS & TRADE-OFFS

Option A: Proceed with the acquisition -> Pros: Potential for enhanced creator support and advertising revenue | Cons: High financial risk, significant time required for ROI.

Option B: Delay acquisition until market conditions stabilise -> Pros: Allows time to reassess financial health and competition | Cons: May miss current market opportunities and delay strategic alignment.

Option C: Pursue a smaller, targeted partnership with an analytics company -> Pros: Reduced financial risk and opportunity to build capability incrementally | Cons: May not have the same market impact as a full acquisition.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

1. Conduct a detailed market analysis to assess the evolving landscape of podcast competition and analytics demand.
2. Develop a financial strategy that identifies potential funding sources to mitigate acquisition risks.
3. Engage in discussions with potential analytics partners to explore incremental collaboration as a preliminary step before a full acquisition.